

are being asked to make adult decisions before they're ready. The secular world makes an almost unbelievable array of temptations available to them at a very young age. God has established the parents to be their buffers. Set your standards according to God's Word and stick to them.

Many times I will volunteer to teach classes at various Christian schools just to get a feel for where Christian families are in the training of their children. I have to be honest and say it's rather depressing, with a few exceptions.

I like to take surveys of how these kids have been trained. I usually ask questions such as: How many are assigned chores that take an hour a week or more? (about 10 percent) How many have to earn their allowances? (about 10 percent) How many receive allowances of \$5 a week or more (about 50 percent) How many believe their parents should control how they spend their money? (about 2 percent) How many have parents that require a budget? (about 2 percent) How many believe their parents handle their money well, based on family arguments? (about 10 percent) How many would like to be like their parents? (about 10 percent)

This is by no means a scientific survey, but it does demonstrate that parents are neglecting a fundamental area of education for their children. If you don't set your own standards and stick to them, your children will be the losers.

(5) *Teach teenagers the principle of budgeting.* Like Dad and Mom, teenagers also should know well the condition of their herds and their flocks (Proverbs 27:23). In other words, they should know where their money goes *before* they spend it.

It is important to me for my children to get my counsel before they get married. A mistake in choosing the right partner can result in grief for a lot of people, me included. My oldest son came and shared that he wanted to get married. After getting to know his fiancée I said, "I approve of your choice; she's a great girl. But before you get married, I want to see a budget that shows what you will earn and how you plan to spend it for the first year." I never doubted his ability to budget in his own family because he budgeted his money